



2020 GRAVE NEW WORLD

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Bharat is late for work, and it's all because of Rakhi Sawant. The final episode of her final reality show *Rakhi Ka Swayamvar Part III* is being aired and, like millions of other Indians, he has to watch, just out of morbid curiosity. The earlier two 'marriages' have, predictably, broken off before they could reach climax but the vicarious power of reality TV and her blatant manipulation of men have endured. She has vowed this would be the real thing and it has to be. Not only is she showing her age, Botox notwithstanding, but last night's TV was a surfer's paradise. There was the day-night cricket match between India and the newly-formed Balochistan Eleven featuring the debut of Sachin Tendulkar's son, Arjun, at Mohali; Prime Minister Rahul Gandhi's inaugural address to the nation beamed from a villager's hut in Amethi and live coverage of the reconstituted G-8 Summit in New Delhi comprising the world's new economic powers, India, China, Brazil, Russia, Indonesia, South Africa, Kenya and Egypt.

Bharat's day is already down the

tube. He is halfway through flipping through the offerings on Kindle, Amazon India's wireless reading device which automatically downloads newspapers and other media content, when he discovers he has misplaced his Unique Identification Card (UIC) launched by the government in 2012 under Nandan Nilekani's stewardship. The UIC is mandatory for all citizens and required for all transactions, from boarding any form of public transport to withdrawing money from banks, entering a public building, buying a house and even purchasing foodstuffs to discourage hoarding in a time of acute food shortages following successive droughts. The biometric-based UIC, which contains all relevant personal details of an individual, has become a key weapon in the war on terror. Losing your UIC is almost a criminal offence.

After a frantic search, he finally finds it under his e-mattress, or erotica-mattress, the sensational new product from Bharat's company that monitors emotional and physical signals and informs couples via a screen



Bharat is late for work, having watched the final episode of *Rakhi Ka Swayamvar Part III*



United Nations Secretary-General Bono announces recognition of Balochistan

